

Talia Honikman

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EXPERIENCE

Ford Motor Company — Palo Alto, CA

Software Engineer & Product Owner, May 2024 – Present

- Owned and shipped two Swift/iOS applications end-to-end as developer and product owner, scaling deployment from 1 to 11 manufacturing plants in five months
- Led specification reviews to translate operational workflows into requirements, edge cases, specs
- Designed and deployed NLP classification pipelines for report routing; documented integration constraints for engineering and QA teams
- Extended a YOLO-based object-detection system from iOS to macOS for assembly workflows; testing validated a measurable reduction in manual QA steps
- Designed and led an internal NLP education series on classification and intent detection, accelerating adoption of the text-classification pipeline across engineering and QA

Emergent Microgrid — Santa Barbara, CA

Product & Content Intern, Mar 2020 – Oct 2020

- Translated technical hardware and integration specs into product narratives; authored PRDs aligning product and marketing; analyzed usage data for customer case studies

SELECTED PROJECTS & WRITING

- **Gricean Maxim Classifier** — Python, RoBERTa, Hugging Face. Transformer model to classify pragmatic maxim violations; hand-annotated corpus with adversarial flouting-vs-violating distinction
- **The Hedge** (Substack) — Essays on formal frameworks and their limits, language and AI from the humanities side, and assorted violin and bad food science

EDUCATION

SPAR — Supervised Program for Alignment Research

Research Fellow (Mentee), Fall 2026 – Present

- Selected from 6,000+ applicants; researching AI welfare self-report robustness under mentor Varad Vishwarupe

BlueDot Impact

AGI Strategy Certification, 2026

- Selective 30-hour cohort course on AI trajectories, threat modeling, and defense-in-depth strategy

Boston University — Boston, MA

BA in Linguistics, 2024

- Capstone: The Effect of Intensifiers on the Perceived Polarity of Utterances
- Relevant coursework: Experimental Pragmatics, Computational Linguistics, Data Structures

ACTIVITIES & PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

- **Tuberculosis Advocacy, TBFighters** (2023–Present) — Helped organize TBFighters' delegation to TB Hill Day as part of a team (Delegate, 2025, California State Captain 2026), including pre-Hill trainings and congressional meetings; briefed congressional offices at TB Hill Day to advocate for restored federal TB funding; profiled in the Stanford Journal of Public Health (2026)
- **Section Violinist, Boston Civic Symphony** (2021–2024)

SKILLS, LANGUAGES & INTERESTS

Technical: Python, Swift, TypeScript/React, SQL, Core ML, RESTful APIs, Git, Xcode, Markdown, Figma, LaTeX

NLP / ML: RoBERTa fine-tuning, Hugging Face, adversarial evaluation set design, stratified k-fold cross-validation, bootstrapped annotation pipelines, object detection (YOLO)

Languages: English (native) · French (B2) · Italian (B1)

Interests: Classical violin, recipe development, distance running, third-tier English football, film photography